

Symphalangus syndactylus

Siamang



Location S.E. Asia

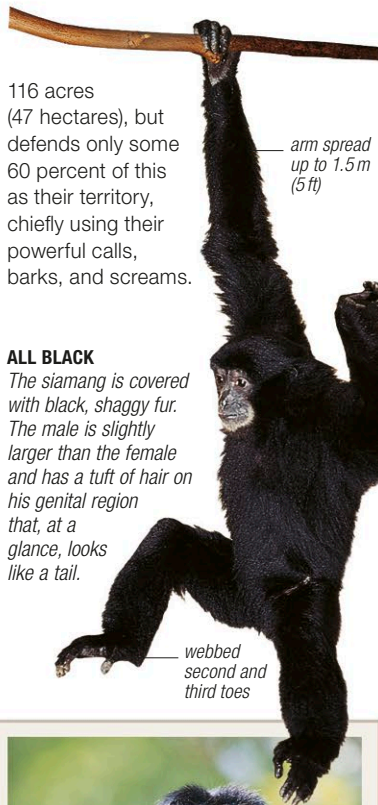
Length 30–35 in (75–90 cm)
Tail None
Weight 19¾–28½ lb (9–13 kg)
Social unit Group/Pair
Status Endangered



The largest gibbon, with a “standing” height of 5 ft (1.5 m), the siamang also has the loudest calls of the group, and the closest-knit families. The female (who is dominant), male, and 1–2 offspring rarely stray more than 100 ft (30 m) from each other, and are usually less than 33 ft (10 m) apart. About three-fifths of their food intake is leaves, and one-third fruits, with a few blossoms and small creatures such as grubs. The family occupies a home range of about

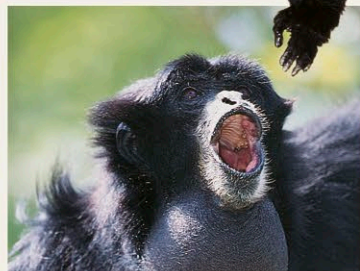
BARKS AND SCREAMS

The siamang’s dark gray, elastic throat skin inflates to the size of a grapefruit, to act as a resonator and amplify its amazingly loud calls. The male’s screams are thought to discourage other males, while the female’s longer, more distinctive series of barklike sounds is associated with territory defense.



ALL BLACK

The siamang is covered with black, shaggy fur. The male is slightly larger than the female and has a tuft of hair on his genital region that, at a glance, looks like a tail.



Nomascus concolor

Black-crested gibbon

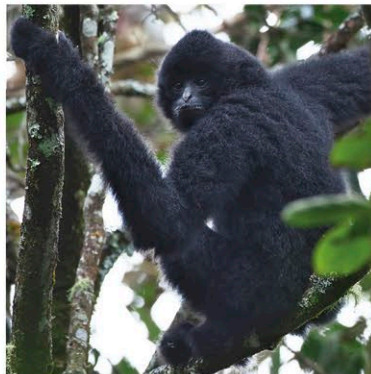


Location S.E. Asia

Length 18–25 in (45–64 cm)
Tail None
Weight 10–20 lb (4.5–9 kg)
Social unit Group/Pair
Status Critically endangered



Unlike most other “flat-headed” gibbons, the black-crested gibbon has long fur on the head crown. The offspring is born with yellow fur, replaced by black fur as it matures; females continue to change to brown or gray. This gibbon eats mainly leaf buds, shoots, and fruit, but rarely animals. It lives in groups, usually a female, a male, and their young.



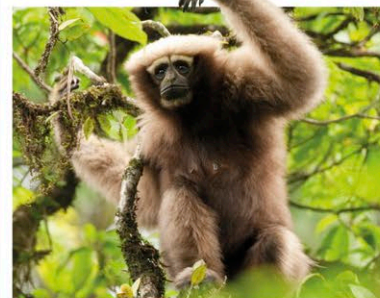
Hoolock tianxing

Skywalker hoolock gibbon



Location Eastern Myanmar, S.W. China

Length 32 in (81 cm)
Tail None
Weight 13–15 lb (5.8–6.8 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Not evaluated



Named after a character from the *Star Wars* film franchise, the skywalker hoolock gibbon (also known as the Gaoligong hoolock gibbon) was originally considered a color variation of the eastern hoolock gibbon (*H. leuconedys*). It is thought to feed mainly on fleshy fruits, but also leaves and flowers, as does the species with which it was originally classified.

Hylobates lar

Lar gibbon



Location S.E. Asia

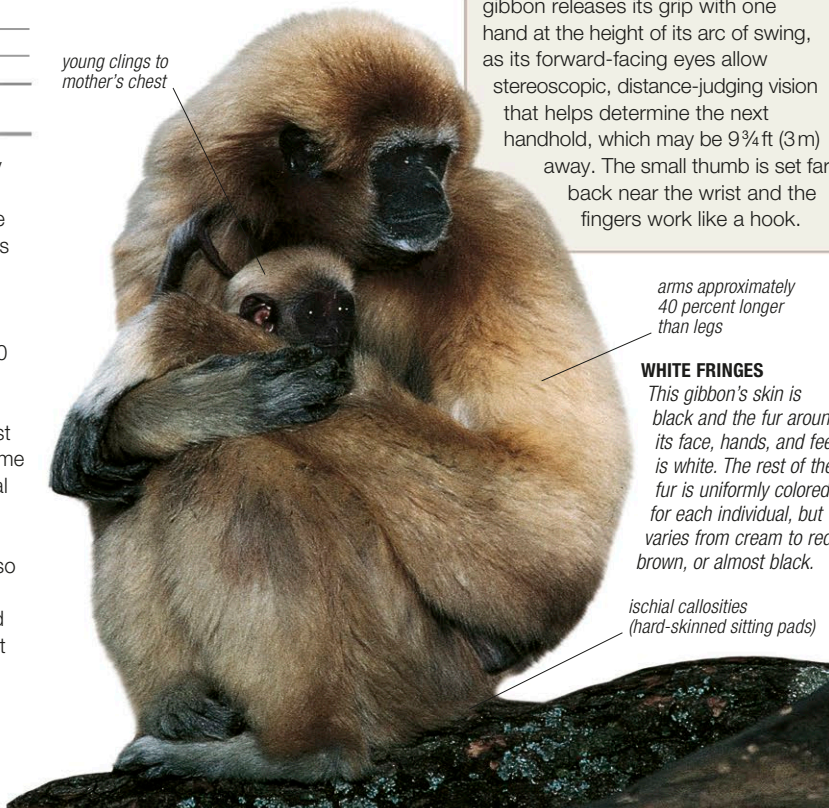
Length 16½–23 in (42–59 cm)
Tail None
Weight 8¾–19 lb (4–8.5 kg)
Social unit Pair
Status Endangered



The lar gibbon becomes active shortly after dawn, when a female and male “duet” to reinforce their pair-bond. She begins with a series of loud, long hoots that rise to a crescendo; the male responds as these fade, with simpler, more tremulous hoots. Each duet, repeated numerous times, lasts 15–20 seconds according to region. Most of this gibbon’s day is spent finding food and eating. Half the diet is fruit, the rest being leaves, insects, and flowers. Some 15 minutes each day is spent in mutual grooming between partners. The lar gibbon rarely moves at night, resting among tree branches or tree forks. Also called the common or white-handed gibbon, the lar gibbon was considered to make lifelong pair-bonds, but recent studies show some serial monogamy with occasional partner changes, and even non-monogamous groupings. Each pair or group defends a territory comprising about three-quarters of its total home range. Gestation is

about 6 months in the wild; the single offspring is suckled for 18 months, is adult size by 6 years, and fully mature by 9 years. Lifespan in the wild averages 25–30 years. Deforestation and hunting by humans are the major threats.

young clings to mother's chest



BRACHIATION

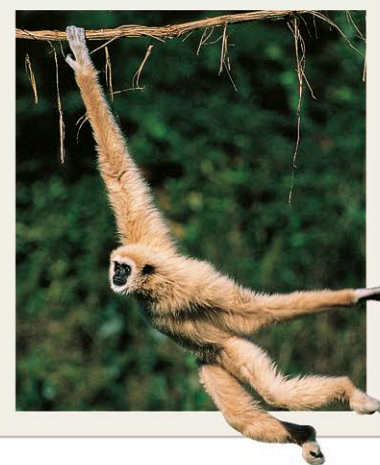
The gibbon’s arm-hanging, hand-swinging method of movement is called brachiation. It saves energy by maintaining momentum, using the body as a pendulum. The lar gibbon releases its grip with one hand at the height of its arc of swing, as its forward-facing eyes allow stereoscopic, distance-judging vision that helps determine the next handhold, which may be 9¾ ft (3 m) away. The small thumb is set far back near the wrist and the fingers work like a hook.

arms approximately 40 percent longer than legs

WHITE FRINGES

This gibbon’s skin is black and the fur around its face, hands, and feet is white. The rest of the fur is uniformly colored for each individual, but varies from cream to red, brown, or almost black.

ischial callosities (hard-skinned sitting pads)



HANDY FEET



The feet of the lar and other gibbons, like the palms of their hands, have bare, leathery-skinned soles for effective grip. The big toe is able to grasp in opposition to the other toes, so that they can walk upright along branches.